

# CAMEROON

JANUARY 2016 – JUNE 2026

Prepared by Africa INSIGHTS Research Team | Vertical: Travel & Tourism

Cameroon's travel perception sits just above neutral but trails every reportable peer, with a thin evidence base that demands urgent data investment.

|                 |          |         |          |            |
|-----------------|----------|---------|----------|------------|
| 16              | 38%      | 38%     | 25%      | 53/100     |
| RECORDS IN VIEW | POSITIVE | NEUTRAL | NEGATIVE | PERCEPTION |

## 01 MONTH IN REVIEW

Cameroon's travel and tourism perception for the January 2016 – June 2026 period is **weakly positive but statistically fragile**: a perception score of **53** on the 0–100 scale, a net sentiment of **12.5**, and a volume of just **16 records** — all of which places every number in the indicative-only category. The dominant story is not a negative destination narrative; it is near-silence. When so few voices are captured, the market effectively does not exist in the international conversation, and absence of presence is itself a competitive liability.

What drove the small positive share was organic pride in Cameroonian culture and landscape — diaspora voices drawing comparisons to other West and Central African cities and celebrating local craft traditions. What drove the negative share was a combination of language-barrier friction for Anglophone visitors and the shadow of regional security concerns, particularly around Boko Haram operations near the northern border. The single highest-engagement negative voice came from a Cameroonian soldier describing the humanitarian toll of that conflict, underscoring that security resonance — even when framed sympathetically — suppresses destination confidence.

The one thing to act on immediately is data acquisition. No strategic decision about messaging, segment targeting, or competitive positioning can rest on 16 records. The tourism board's first investment should be a systematic programme to surface and index visitor-generated content — reviews, social commentary, travel blog coverage — so that the next reporting cycle has a defensible evidence base.

### DATA NOTE

This view holds only 16 records, well below the 50-record threshold for a reliable read. Every figure in this report is indicative only and should not be used to set strategic direction on its own.

### DATA NOTE

No theme reaches the 15-mention floor required to headline a finding; the thematic analysis describes the mix without ranking any theme as dominant.

### DATA NOTE

There is insufficient volume spread across periods to read a reliable direction of travel; trend data is shown for completeness only.

## 02 PERCEPTION OVERVIEW

Cameroon's **perception score of 53** places the destination marginally above the scale's neutral midpoint of 50. The accompanying **net sentiment of 12.5** reflects a positive-minus-negative margin that is real but slender. The breakdown — **37.5% positive, 37.5% neutral, 25.0% negative** — is the most telling element of the picture: the equal weight of positive and neutral voices suggests that most people who comment on Cameroon do so without strong feeling, neither advocating for it nor warning against it. That neutrality is characteristic of a destination that has not yet built a clear emotional proposition in the minds of travellers.

The negative share at **25.0%** is not catastrophic in isolation, but in a corpus this small it represents only four records capable of disproportionate influence on aggregated scores. Equally, the six positive records cannot be read as a groundswell of advocacy. What the mix implies is a destination that generates mild curiosity and occasional warm endorsement among those who engage with it, but has not produced the volume of enthusiastic, shareable, positive content that converts curiosity into bookings. The strategic imperative embedded in these numbers is visibility, not reputation repair.

### DATA NOTE

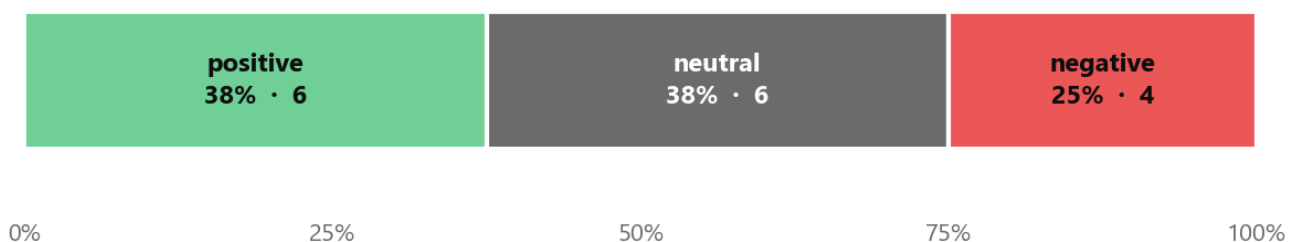
The 16-record sample is below the 50-record minimum threshold; all sentiment percentages and scores are indicative only and should not be cited as statistically robust findings.

### DATA NOTE

Net sentiment and perception score are derived from the available sample as provided; no further calculation has been applied.

**Figure 1 — Sentiment breakdown**

How the 16 records in view split across sentiment classes. Net sentiment is +12 points.



## 03 THEMATIC ANALYSIS

Five thematic areas appear in the data — scenery, hospitality, housing, safety, and weather — but **none reaches the 15-mention floor required to headline a finding**. The analysis therefore describes the character of what is present rather than ranking themes by importance. Scenery and hospitality each draw six mentions and together account for the majority of thematic commentary. Scenery carries a positive lean: a commentator in March 2024 comparing Limbe to Nigeria's Calabar — "so beautiful... so green and a sea port city too" (@georgesk5285, Mar 2024) — illustrates the kind of organic, cross-border pride that positions Cameroon's coastal and highland landscapes favourably within a West and Central African frame. This is the destination's most natural asset for imagery-led marketing.

Hospitality presents a more mixed signal. Its six mentions split across positive, neutral, and negative in roughly equal measure. The most resonant negative voice does not attack Cameroonians' warmth directly; rather,

@tsechristianchi6221 (Jul 2023) describes the human cost of Boko Haram operations near the northern border, a comment that attracted **156 engagements** — by far the highest of any voice in the dataset and the one most likely to shape how casual readers perceive the destination's safety context. A separate visitor account of language-barrier discomfort — "They were speaking French and pointing and then rolling their eyes" (@kmchuckles4783, Jan 2022) — and a March 2026 warning about scams (@djamimadi2473, Mar 2026) round out the negative hospitality register. These voices point to two actionable friction points: the Anglophone visitor experience in Francophone urban centres, and the perception of petty crime risk.

The positive emotional undercurrent in the data deserves separate attention. A diaspora voice celebrating traditional brick-making — "exactly how we make our bricks in my village in Western Cameroon, proudly African!" (@honoresangwa1000, Dec 2022) — and a diaspora-return planning narrative about building a retirement home (@audreychanetngaleu1966, Apr 2021) indicate that the diaspora community is an active, emotionally invested source of positive content. This segment is currently doing more reputational work for Cameroon than any formal campaign, and it is doing so unprompted.

#### DATA NOTE

No theme in this dataset reaches the 15-mention minimum required to headline a finding; all thematic observations are indicative only.

#### DATA NOTE

Housing, safety, and weather each carry a single mention and cannot support any directional conclusion.

#### DATA NOTE

The 156-engagement voice on the Boko Haram conflict is noted for its relative reach within the dataset, but the absolute engagement figure is small by platform standards and cannot be extrapolated to broader audience impact without additional data.

### Voices behind the numbers

The most-engaged supportive and critical mentions in this view. Emoji and non-Latin characters are stripped for print.

**POSITIVE** · @honoresangwa1000 · Dec 2022 · 21 likes · score +0.57

"11:00 That is exactly how we make our bricks in my village in Western Cameroon, proudly African!"

**POSITIVE** · @audreychanetngaleu1966 · Apr 2021 · 20 likes · score +0.83

"Great content! Husband is from Cameroon and I'm from new Orleans. We are planning to build a retirement home in Cameroon and will definitely hire security. Thanks!"

**NEGATIVE** · @tsechristianchi6221 · Jul 2023 · 156 likes · score -0.74

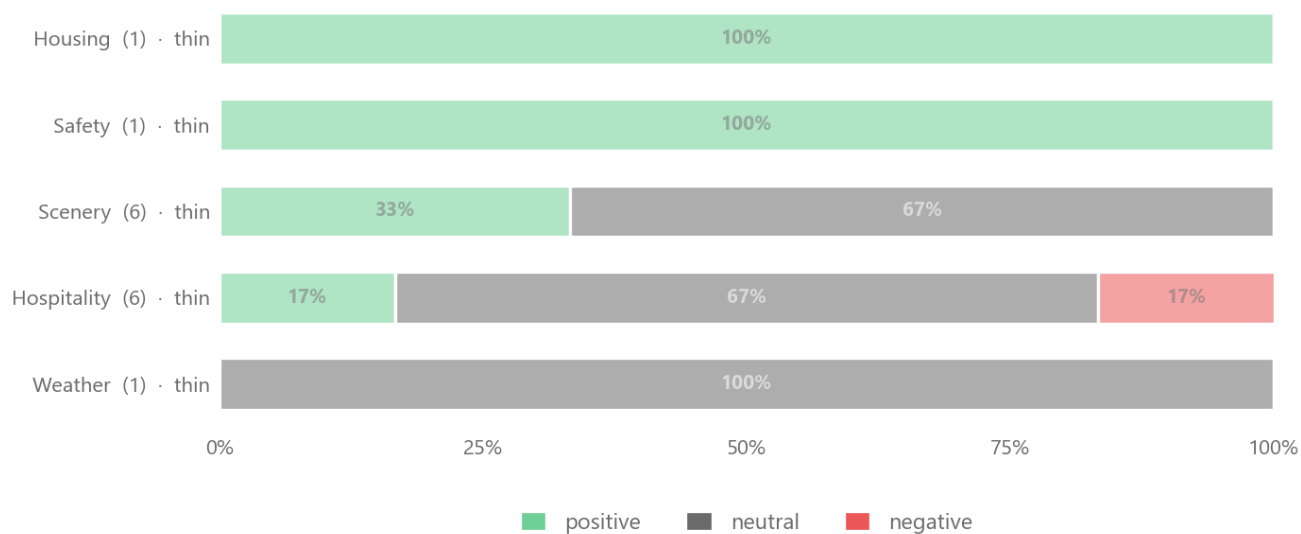
"I'm a cameroonian soldier and have done a mission on boko haram in borno state, Gambaru, wulgo local government area and to say it's too sad to see a vibrant population suffering. But thank God we pushed them away and restore the wulgo local government with a population of about 5k people"

**NEGATIVE** · @djamimadi2473 · Mar 2026 · 1 likes · score -0.69

"Désolée pour toi et courage à toi, fait attention trop d'arnaquer À quand ta visite au Cameroun on a hâte de te voirici"

**Figure 2 — Sentiment by theme**

Every travel theme mentioned in this view, ranked by net sentiment. Mention counts in brackets; themes below the 15-mention floor are faded and marked thin.



## 04 VISITOR SEGMENTS

Segment data exists for two cohorts — adventure and luxury — but **neither clears the 50-record threshold required for reportable analysis**, and no cohort-to-cohort comparison is therefore possible. The adventure cohort comprises **4 records** and the luxury cohort **1 record**; together they account for **31.2%** of classified records, with **11 records unclassified** by segment. The picture that emerges is one of extreme data thinness rather than meaningful segment differentiation.

What the indicative figures suggest — and the tourism board should treat this as directional hypothesis only, to be tested with a larger sample — is that the adventure cohort's perception score of **46** sits below the scale's neutral midpoint, while the single luxury record scores **55**. This would imply that those seeking active or nature-based experiences in Cameroon may face friction that more comfort-oriented visitors do not — perhaps related to infrastructure gaps or the security context in outlying areas. However, given the record counts involved, this pattern carries no statistical weight whatsoever, and no targeting decision should rest on it.

The practical implication is that Cameroon's segment intelligence is essentially blank. The tourism board cannot currently answer which type of traveller it is best placed to serve, nor which is most likely to generate positive word-of-mouth at scale. Building segment visibility — through structured review collection at lodges, parks, and business hotels — is a prerequisite for any segment-led marketing strategy.

### DATA NOTE

No visitor cohort reaches the 50-record minimum threshold; adventure and luxury figures are indicative only and no cohort comparison is statistically supported.

### DATA NOTE

Only 31.2% of records were classified by segment; 11 records could not be attributed to a traveller type, further limiting any segment-level interpretation.

### DATA NOTE

Business and budget traveller cohorts produced no records in this dataset; no commentary on those segments is possible.

| VISITOR SEGMENT  | RECORDS | SHARE OF VIEW | PERCEPTION | NET  |
|------------------|---------|---------------|------------|------|
| Adventure · thin | 4       | 25.0%         | 46/100     | +0   |
| Luxury · thin    | 1       | 6.2%          | 55/100     | +100 |

## 05 COMPETITIVE BENCHMARKING

Cameroon's position in the peer group is unambiguous: with a perception score of **53**, it sits below every reportable comparator in the benchmarking set. Tanzania leads the group at **73**, followed by Ghana, Rwanda, and Senegal each at **70**, Kenya at **69**, Zimbabwe at **68**, South Africa at **65**, Egypt at **64**, and Nigeria at **62**. Morocco, the only peer scoring below Cameroon among those with reportable samples, records **39** — but Morocco's figure rests on **52 records** and reflects a strongly negative sentiment profile, a different problem from Cameroon's near-invisibility.

A critical caveat governs this comparison: **Cameroon's own score is not reportable**, as its 16-record sample falls far below the 50-record threshold. The gap between Cameroon and the nearest reportable peer, Nigeria at **62**, spans the 10-point margin the research team requires before stating a gap — but because Cameroon's score is indicative rather than reliable, this gap cannot be asserted with confidence. What can be said with confidence is that every peer country in this set has generated the kind of volume that produces statistically defensible perception intelligence, and Cameroon has not.

The structural disadvantage is therefore twofold. Cameroon trails peers on the scores that are available, and it lacks the data infrastructure to prove or disprove that gap. Among the comparators, Tanzania's strong positive share of **70.8%** and Kenya's position as the highest-volume market at **2,075 records** illustrate what sustained traveller engagement and content generation can produce. Rwanda's score of **70** on **1,526 records** is particularly instructive: it demonstrates that a smaller, landlocked African destination with a complex recent history can build a leading perception position through deliberate investment in visitor experience and content strategy. Cameroon's natural assets — its coastal scenery, highland landscapes, and biodiversity — are objectively competitive, but they are not generating the visitor voice that turns assets into perception.

### DATA NOTE

Cameroon's own perception score is not reportable (16 records, below the 50-record threshold); it appears in the peer table for orientation only and no gap against any peer can be stated with statistical confidence.

### DATA NOTE

No theme-level cross-country gaps are available; aspect-gap analysis requires both a reportable Cameroon theme and a reportable peer theme, and neither condition is met.

### DATA NOTE

Morocco's score of 39 is based on 52 records and is reportable, but the comparison with Cameroon's non-reportable score is noted here for context only.

| MARKET   | RECORDS | PERCEPTION | NET SENTIMENT |
|----------|---------|------------|---------------|
| Tanzania | 1,326   | 73/100     | +59           |
| Ghana    | 1,094   | 70/100     | +52           |
| Rwanda   | 1,526   | 70/100     | +54           |
| Senegal  | 1,114   | 70/100     | +50           |

|              |       |        |     |
|--------------|-------|--------|-----|
| Kenya        | 2,075 | 69/100 | +52 |
| Zimbabwe     | 1,186 | 68/100 | +50 |
| South Africa | 2,164 | 65/100 | +39 |
| Egypt        | 2,305 | 64/100 | +36 |
| Nigeria      | 1,884 | 62/100 | +33 |
| Morocco      | 52    | 39/100 | -21 |

## 06 TRENDS & SIGNALS

The trend data spans eight measured periods from **2016 to 2026**, but the research team flags it as **not readable as a reliable direction of travel**: most individual periods rest on a single record, and single-record years are as likely to reflect which one voice was captured as they are to reflect genuine shifts in perception. The overall arc — from a perception score of **94.0** in 2016 to **42.0** in 2026, a change of **-52.0 points** — is marked as **declining** in direction, but this headline movement is heavily influenced by extreme single-year readings. A score of **94.0** on one record in 2016 and **13.0** on one record in 2023 are data artefacts as much as signals.

The period with the largest sample — **2026, with six records** — is the closest approximation to a reliable reading the trend series offers. Its perception score of **42.0** and negative share of **16.7%** put the current moment below the scale's neutral midpoint, which is consistent with the overall dataset's position just above neutral when all periods are aggregated. The **2025** reading, on a single record with **100% negative sentiment**, is the most recent single-year signal before 2026 and contributed to the declining label — but again, one record cannot carry that weight analytically.

The one genuine signal the trend data yields is the **absence of consistent positive momentum at any point in the decade**. Even in years with relatively high scores — 2021 at **91.0**, 2024 at **86.0** — volume was too thin to translate into compounding reputation. Destinations build perception through accumulated positive content, not sporadic high scores. The signal for the tourism board is not that sentiment has deteriorated; it is that the pipeline of positive content has never been switched on at sufficient scale.

### DATA NOTE

The trend series is flagged as not readable for reliable direction; most individual period scores rest on a single record and should be treated as illustrative only.

### DATA NOTE

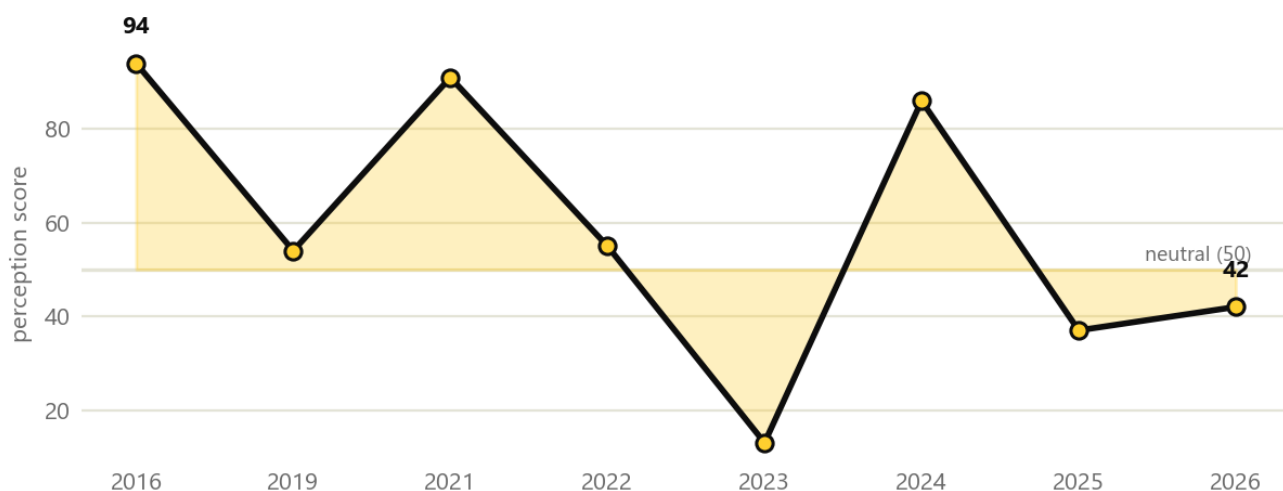
The overall change of -52.0 points from 2016 to 2026 is provided in the fact pack but cannot be interpreted as a measured decline given the single-record basis of the first year.

### DATA NOTE

No aspect-level trend data is available; movement analysis is limited to the overall perception score.

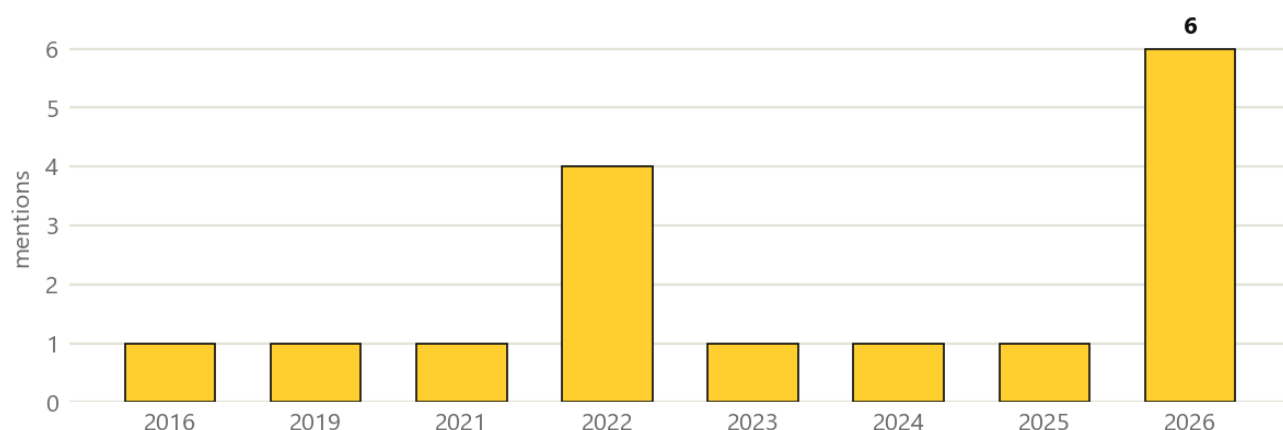
**Figure 3 — Perception over time (by year)**

Perception score per period on a 0–100 scale, where 50 is neutral.



**Figure 4 — Conversation volume (by year)**

Records per period. Read the trend above against this: a swing on thin volume is noise.



## 07 RECOMMENDATIONS

The most urgent recommendation follows directly from the data's most critical finding: **the entire evidence base is too thin to support strategic decision-making**. The tourism board's first priority should be a structured content-seeding and review-collection programme targeting the platforms most likely to generate indexable visitor opinion — Google Hotels, TripAdvisor, and YouTube travel content. This means partnering with lodges, national park operators, and city hotels to activate post-visit review prompts, and commissioning a small number of high-quality creator visits to generate the initial content mass. The target audience for this effort is the board's own data pipeline; without it, every subsequent recommendation is operating blind.

The diaspora voice is currently Cameroon's most active and most positive content generator, as the retirement-home planning narrative and the village brick-making pride commentary both illustrate. The tourism board should formalise this by launching a diaspora ambassador programme that gives Cameroonian communities in North America and Europe the tools — short-form video prompts, branded hashtags, event tie-ins — to produce and share destination content. Diaspora-linked travel is also a segment with above-average dwell times and spending propensity; activating it costs far less than acquiring cold international visitors and is likely to produce faster perception movement.

The Anglophone visitor friction documented in the dataset — language-barrier discomfort in Francophone urban environments — is a fixable product gap that the board can address in partnership with the hospitality sector. A targeted training and signage programme for hotels and tour operators in Douala and Yaoundé, focused on English-language welcome capacity, would directly reduce the negative hospitality signals captured in the data. This recommendation targets accommodation and tour operator associations as the implementing partners and should be framed as a quick-win that costs little but visibly improves the experience of the English-speaking African diaspora and Anglophone international visitor — both high-value segments.

Finally, the regional security narrative — amplified by the single highest-engagement voice in the entire dataset, concerning Boko Haram operations near the northern border — requires proactive communications management rather than silence. The tourism board should develop a clear geographic distinction in all marketing materials between the affected far-north region and the country's primary tourism assets: the coastal city of Limbe, Mount Cameroon, the western highlands, and Douala's urban culture. Conflating Cameroon's security complexity with its tourism heartland suppresses demand from visitors who would otherwise be excellent candidates for the destination. This messaging correction targets international travel media, tour operators in source markets, and travel advisors who currently may be applying a blanket risk assessment to the whole country.

#### DATA NOTE

All recommendations are framed as directional priorities informed by indicative data only; none should be budgeted or evaluated against the perception scores in this report until a minimum 50-record sample is achieved in a subsequent reporting cycle.

#### DATA NOTE

The diaspora segment is identified qualitatively from voice content; no segment-level volume or perception data is available to quantify its size or current share of visitor arrivals.

## 08 METHODOLOGY & PROVENANCE

|                       |                                                                                |
|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Country               | Cameroon                                                                       |
| Year range            | 2015–2026                                                                      |
| Aspect (any of)       | all aspects                                                                    |
| Sentiment             | positive, neutral, negative                                                    |
| Data source           | all                                                                            |
| Relevant records only | yes                                                                            |
| Period                | January 2016 – June 2026                                                       |
| Records               | 16                                                                             |
| Generated             | 19 Aug 2026 12:19 UTC                                                          |
| Narrative             | Written by claude-sonnet-4-6; every figure verified against the computed data. |

Evidence base: 15 YouTube comments, 1 Google Hotels review. 100% of records were attributed to this market from what the text itself is about rather than from the query that surfaced them. Sentiment is scored by a multilingual transformer; themes, emotion and visitor segment are rule-based taggers. Evidence thresholds: 50 records for a reliable view, 15 mentions before a theme can headline a finding, 5 points before a theme counts as praised or criticised, 10 points before a cross-country gap is stated. Every figure in this report is computed from the filtered records by the analysis pipeline. The written analysis interprets those figures; each number it states is verified back against them before publication, and any section that fails verification is replaced by the deterministic summary.